

What every tier is worth, and what the evidence carries

Five tiers, each tested against what a firm of that size actually pays elsewhere. Prices are compared on what a customer locks at signature rather than on the printed card, because the locked price is what the plan collects and what a reader will check. Every comparable is a published price or an observed contract figure with its publisher named. Where no comparable exists the tier says so instead of reaching for one.

5

TIERS ON
THE CARD

4

WITH A PUBLISHED
COMPARABLE

1

WITH NO COMPARABLE
FOUND ANYWHERE

\$105.3M

2031 REVENUE
ON THIS CARD

49.7%

OF IT FROM
THE SUBSCRIPTION

1 Start here

A rate card is the list of prices a company charges, one for each size of customer. This one has five sizes, from a payment firm with a handful of staff up to a bank or a stablecoin issuer. What it buys is safeguarding: holding customer money apart from the company's own, and proving every day that it is all still there. Three things need to be understood before any number below means anything.

What a firm pays rises once, and then never again for that firm

The step falls on 1 January 2028. Whatever a firm signs at, it keeps for as long as it stays. A small firm signing in 2027 pays \$32,837 every year it remains a customer. The firm next door that waits until 2028 pays \$36,813 every year. Neither is ever repriced, so the 2027 column is a closing price rather than a discount.

The comparison is made on the locked price, never on the card

The card is what appears on the rate sheet. The locked price is what a customer actually pays and what the model collects. Our card against a competitor's signed contract flatters us by twenty five per cent, so every table compares signed against signed.

What a comparable is, and what it is not

A published price is a figure on a vendor's own site. An observed contract figure is what buyers actually paid, compiled by a third party from real purchases, with the sample size stated. Both are used. Neither is a list price, because sixteen of the twenty three products checked publish nothing at all.

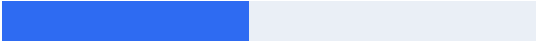
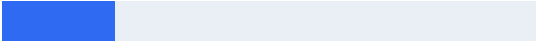
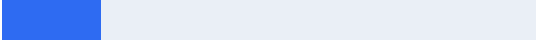
2 The whole card, in one table

The card is one price per tier, held flat for the life of the model. What a firm actually pays depends on the year it signs, and it keeps that price. The last column converts the locked price to United States dollars, which is the currency almost every comparable is quoted in.

Tier	Who it is	The card, held flat	Signing in 2027	Signing from 2028	Locked, in US dollars
Command and institution	A bank, a stablecoin issuer, a market infrastructure	\$687,000	\$766,005	\$858,750	US\$618,919
Enterprise and complex	A crypto trading platform, several regulated entities under one filing	\$219,500	\$244,743	\$274,375	US\$197,748
Mid market regulated	An established payment provider with a real compliance function	\$83,250	\$92,824	\$104,063	US\$75,000
Small regulated firm	A payment firm with a handful of staff	\$29,450	\$32,837	\$36,813	US\$26,532
Partner and white label	A reviewer, an association or a platform reselling to its own customers	\$130,000	\$144,950	\$162,500	US\$117,117

Legend. Foreign figures converted at the Bank of Canada daily rates of 14 August 2026, 1.3875 for the United States dollar and 1.8790 for the pound sterling. Our figure is the price a firm locks signing from 1 January 2028 and keeps for as long as it stays. Source: 4orm Finance master pro forma of 17 August 2026, base case.

SUBSCRIPTION REVENUE BY TIER, 2031, ON THIS CARD

Small regulated firm		\$20,666,383	631 firms
Mid market regulated		\$13,929,422	156 firms
Enterprise and complex		\$9,529,988	41 firms
Partner and white label		\$4,353,064	31 partners
Command and institution		\$3,800,355	6 institutions

Bars start at zero and run to \$20,666,383. Together they are the subscription line, \$52,279,213 in 2031, which is 49.7 per cent of total revenue of \$105,276,946. Firm counts are the closing base at 31 December 2031, rounded. The smallest tier carries the most money and the largest tier carries the least, which is why the evidence below is weighted the way it is.

3 The small regulated firm, at \$36,813 locked

This is the tier that carries the plan: 631 of the 835 customers at 2031 and \$20,666,383 of the revenue. It is also the tier most likely to refuse, so it is tested hardest.

Comparable	What it is	Their price	In Canadian dollars
ComplyAdvantage Starter	Screening 100 names against lists	US\$99.99 a month	\$1,665
Sumsub Compliance floor	Identity checks, minimum commitment	US\$299 a month	\$4,978
Record keeping and storage	One adviser's estimate for a Canadian provider	from US\$12,000	\$16,650
Vanta startup tier	Evidence automation, under 50 staff	US\$12,000 to \$28,000	\$16,650 to \$38,850
Drata, under 50 staff	Evidence automation, one framework	US\$12,000 to \$28,000	\$16,650 to \$38,850
Kani Payments entry	British safeguarding and scheme reporting	from US\$2,000 a month	\$33,300
Guardexia Core	British safeguarding, one entity	GBP 1,500 a month	\$33,822
Drata, observed median	127 deals compiled by a third party	US\$24,868	\$34,504
AuditBoard small programme	One module, under 15 users	US\$25,000 to \$60,000	\$34,688 to \$83,250
4orm Finance, locked from 2028	The daily record, kept and produced	US\$26,532	\$36,813

Legend. Foreign figures converted at the Bank of Canada daily rates of 14 August 2026, 1.3875 for the United States dollar and 1.8790 for the pound sterling. Our figure is the price a firm locks signing from 1 January 2028 and keeps for as long as it stays. Source: 4orm Finance master pro forma of 17 August 2026, base case.

It sits inside the band, above the middle of it, and below every ceiling

US\$26,532 is 6.7 per cent above the observed Drata median, 10.6 per cent above the Kani entry price, and 56 per cent below the ceiling of the AuditBoard small programme band. Against the two point tools it is between seven and twenty two times more, and that gap is the objection to prepare for, because a screening subscription answers one question and keeps no record.

4 What the small tier is worth to the plan

Moving this tier twenty per cent in each direction, with the rest of the ladder held, shows how much of the plan rests on it. The answer is less than the customer count suggests.

Card	Locked from 2028	2031 revenue	Lowest month on the road	Months overdrawn
\$35,340	\$44,175	\$110,249,278	(\$699,432)	7
\$29,450	\$36,813	\$105,276,946	(\$778,960)	8
\$23,560	\$29,450	\$100,304,614	(\$858,489)	8

Legend. Each row was produced by moving that one tier in the workbook and recalculating every tab, with the rest of the ladder held where it is set. Lowest month is the low point on the monthly cash map, which runs from the pre seed close to two months past the seed. Negatives in parentheses. The rows above and below the set price bound the question in both directions and are not proposals.

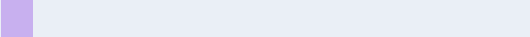
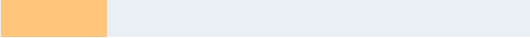
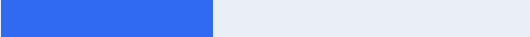
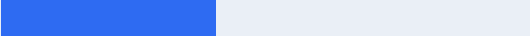
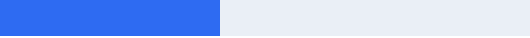
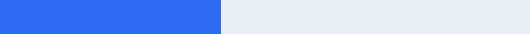
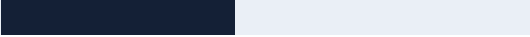
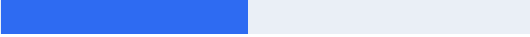
1 Three quarters of the logos, a fifth of the money

- 631 of 835 customers, and \$20,666,383 of \$105,276,946.
- A twenty per cent cut costs 4.7 per cent of 2031 revenue.
- The risk this tier carries is signing 631 firms, not what each one pays.
- So the price is a go to market decision rather than a lever on the headline.

2 Where it would have to fall to break

- At \$23,560 on the card the plan still clears \$100M in 2031.
- The road to the seed deepens by \$79,529 and holds at eight months.
- Nothing in the model breaks at any price tested.
- That is evidence for the price, because the plan is not leaning on it.

WHERE THE SMALL TIER LOCKED PRICE SITS AGAINST ITS COMPARABLES

Sumsb Compliance floor		\$4,978	identity checks
Record keeping estimate		\$16,650	Canadian adviser
Kani entry		\$33,300	British safeguarding
Guardexia Core		\$33,822	British safeguarding
Drata observed median		\$34,504	127 deals
AuditBoard small, floor		\$34,688	band floor
4orm locked from 2028		\$36,813	this plan
Vanta, top of band		\$38,850	band ceiling
AuditBoard small, ceiling		\$83,250	band ceiling

Bars start at zero and run to \$83,250, all annual and in Canadian dollars. ComplyAdvantage at \$1,665 is omitted because it renders as a hairline at this scale; it appears in the table on the previous page.

5 The mid market regulated firm, at \$104,063 locked

An established payment provider with a compliance function of its own, several bank relationships and more than one product line. 156 firms at 2031 and \$13,929,422 of revenue. This tier was raised during the review, from a card of \$68,700 to \$83,250, because the evidence showed the old price sitting on the floor of the observed band rather than inside it.

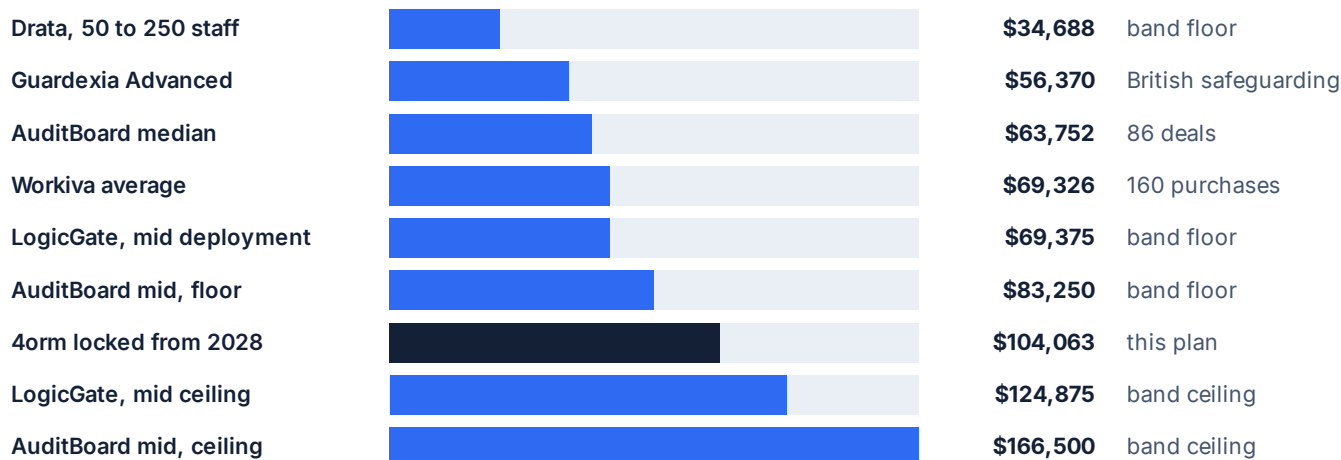
Comparable	What it is	Their price	In Canadian dollars
Vanta, 51 to 200 staff	Evidence automation, one or two frameworks	US\$25,000 to \$55,000	\$34,688 to \$76,313
Drata, 50 to 250 staff	Evidence automation, one or two frameworks	US\$25,000 to \$50,000	\$34,688 to \$69,375
Guardexia Advanced	British safeguarding plus capital adequacy	GBP 2,500 a month	\$56,370
AuditBoard, observed median	86 deals compiled by a third party	US\$45,947	\$63,752
LogicGate, three to six applications	Configurable risk workflows	US\$50,000 to \$90,000	\$69,375 to \$124,875
Workiva, average contract	160 purchases compiled by a third party	US\$49,957	\$69,315
AuditBoard mid programme	Two or three modules, 15 to 40 users	US\$60,000 to \$120,000	\$83,250 to \$166,500
4orm Finance, locked from 2028	The daily record, kept and produced	US\$75,000	\$104,063

Legend. Foreign figures converted at the Bank of Canada daily rates of 14 August 2026, 1.3875 for the United States dollar and 1.8790 for the pound sterling. Our figure is the price a firm locks signing from 1 January 2028 and keeps for as long as it stays. Source: 4orm Finance master pro forma of 17 August 2026, base case.

Card	Locked from 2028	2031 revenue	Lowest month on the road	Months overdrawn
\$99,900	\$124,875	\$108,628,365	(\$747,227)	8
\$83,250	\$104,063	\$105,276,946	(\$778,960)	8
\$66,600	\$83,250	\$101,925,527	(\$810,694)	8

Legend. Each row was produced by moving that one tier in the workbook and recalculating every tab, with the rest of the ladder held where it is set. Lowest month is the low point on the monthly cash map, which runs from the pre seed close to two months past the seed. Negatives in parentheses. The rows above and below the set price bound the question in both directions and are not proposals.

6 Where the mid market price lands



Bars start at zero and run to \$166,500. All figures annual, in Canadian dollars. Band floor and band ceiling mark the two ends of a range a vendor or a third party publishes, so a single product can appear twice.

Mid band, with a ceiling above it in two directions

US\$75,000 sits in the middle of the AuditBoard mid programme band rather than on its floor, and below the LogicGate mid deployment ceiling. It is above the AuditBoard observed median and above the Workiva average, both of which are single platform figures for products that assemble filings rather than hold a funds position. This is where the evidence supports the tier sitting, and moving it further would mean arguing against Workiva's average across 6,750 customers.

The move was worth \$2,928,718 in 2031. Raising the card from \$68,700 to \$83,250 took mid market revenue from \$11,494,910 to \$13,929,422 and total revenue from \$102,348,228 to \$105,276,946, on the same customer count and with no other change to the model. Total revenue rises by more than the tier does, because three other lines are priced as a share of the subscription.

1 Why this tier had room and the small one did not

- The old mid market card converted to US\$49,514, near the Workiva average contract.
- The old locked price converted to US\$61,892, which is the floor of the mid band.
- So the tier was sitting at the bottom of its evidence rather than inside it.
- The small tier was already above its median, which is why it moved less.

2 Where the evidence stops carrying it

- Above US\$75,000 the argument runs against Workiva's average across 6,750 customers.
- That is a fight for the enterprise tier, not this one.
- 156 firms at 2031 makes this the second largest tier by revenue.
- A further twenty per cent would add \$3.4M and cost the cleanest benchmark we have.

7 The enterprise and complex firm, at \$274,375 locked

Several regulated entities filing under one registration, or a crypto asset trading platform carrying both a safeguarding duty and an anti money laundering one. 41 firms at 2031 and \$9,529,988 of revenue. Raised during the review from a card of \$206,100 to \$219,500.

Comparable	What it is	Their price	In Canadian dollars
Hyperproof, average contract	44 purchases compiled by a third party	US\$41,400	\$57,443
Guardexia multi jurisdiction	British safeguarding across two jurisdictions	GBP 3,500 a month	\$78,918
Vanta, 201 to 500 staff	Evidence automation, two to four frameworks	US\$50,000 to \$110,000	\$69,375 to \$152,625
Drata, 250 staff and above	Evidence automation, multiple frameworks	US\$60,000 to \$120,000	\$83,250 to \$166,500
Workiva, top of observed range	160 purchases compiled by a third party	US\$153,530	\$213,023
AuditBoard enterprise	Four or more modules, many entities	US\$120,000 to \$250,000	\$166,500 to \$346,875
LogicGate, six or more applications	Configurable risk workflows, premium add ons	US\$100,000 to \$200,000	\$138,750 to \$277,500
4orm Finance, locked from 2028	The daily record, kept and produced	US\$197,748	\$274,375

Legend. Foreign figures converted at the Bank of Canada daily rates of 14 August 2026, 1.3875 for the United States dollar and 1.8790 for the pound sterling. Our figure is the price a firm locks signing from 1 January 2028 and keeps for as long as it stays. Source: 4orm Finance master pro forma of 17 August 2026, base case.

Card	Locked from 2028	2031 revenue	Lowest month on the road	Months overdrawn
\$263,400	\$329,250	\$107,569,861	(\$758,100)	8
\$219,500	\$274,375	\$105,276,946	(\$778,960)	8
\$175,600	\$219,500	\$102,984,030	(\$799,821)	8

Legend. Each row was produced by moving that one tier in the workbook and recalculating every tab, with the rest of the ladder held where it is set. Lowest month is the low point on the monthly cash map, which runs from the pre seed close to two months past the seed. Negatives in parentheses. The rows above and below the set price bound the question in both directions and are not proposals.

8 The command and institution customer, at \$858,750 locked

A bank, a Canadian dollar stablecoin issuer or a market infrastructure. Six customers at 2031 and \$3,800,355 of revenue, which is the smallest tier by money and the largest by price. It was held where it was during the review, and the reason is on this page.

Comparable	What it is	Their price	In Canadian dollars
Riskconnect, one published case	Licensing only, financial services customer	from US\$283,000	\$392,663
MetricStream, mid market	50 to 150 named users	US\$350,000 to \$600,000	\$485,625 to \$832,500
Workiva, above US\$500,000	276 customers of 6,750, which is four per cent	above US\$500,000	above \$693,750
MetricStream, healthcare system	200 to 400 named users	US\$750,000 to \$1,100,000	\$1,040,625 to \$1,526,250
MetricStream, large enterprise	300 to 600 named users	US\$1,200,000 to \$1,800,000	\$1,665,000 to \$2,497,500
4orm Finance, locked from 2028	The daily record, kept and produced	US\$618,919	\$858,750

Legend. Riskconnect's only published figure is a single case study it wrote itself, so the sample is one. MetricStream publishes no price and the bands are a third party analysis with no sample size disclosed. Both are recorded because this tier had no comparable at all before they were found. Foreign figures converted at the Bank of Canada daily rates of 14 August 2026, 1.3875 for the United States dollar and 1.8790 for the pound sterling. Our figure is the price a firm locks signing from 1 January 2028 and keeps for as long as it stays. Source: 4orm Finance master pro forma of 17 August 2026, base case.

Held, because moving it buys almost nothing and costs the strongest evidence in the ladder

At \$858,750 locked the tier sits above the Workiva threshold that 276 of its 6,750 customers clear, inside the MetricStream mid market band, and well below its large enterprise band. Raising the card twenty per cent adds \$914,365 to 2031 revenue and does not move the road to the seed by a single dollar, because no command customer signs before 2029. Six customers on the thinnest evidence is not where to push.

9

The partner and white label tier, at \$162,500 locked

An independent reviewer, an industry association or a platform reselling the product to its own customers. 31 partners at 2031 and \$4,353,064 of revenue. This is the one tier with no comparable found anywhere, and the document says so rather than reaching for a proxy.

What was searched	Every vendor in the set was checked for a reseller, channel, white label or association price. None publishes one. The reconciliation specialists sell direct. The evidence platforms sell direct. No published comparable for a reviewer or association channel was found in any market.
How the number was set	Judgement, anchored on the mid market price multiplied by a seat count. A partner resells to several firms, so the fee behaves as a platform minimum rather than as a per firm price.
What it is worth	Moving it twenty per cent in each direction moves 2031 revenue by about a million dollars either way, from \$104,229,598 to \$106,324,293, and moves the road to the seed by less than thirty thousand dollars.
What should happen to it	It should be marked as an assumption wherever it appears until a benchmark exists. Raising a price with no comparable behind it adds exposure without adding any defence, which is why it was held during the review.

Card	Locked from 2028	2031 revenue	Lowest month on the road	Months overdrawn
\$156,000	\$195,000	\$106,324,293	(\$750,411)	8
\$130,000	\$162,500	\$105,276,946	(\$778,960)	8
\$104,000	\$130,000	\$104,229,598	(\$807,510)	8

Legend. Each row was produced by moving that one tier in the workbook and recalculating every tab, with the rest of the ladder held where it is set. Lowest month is the low point on the monthly cash map, which runs from the pre seed close to two months past the seed. Negatives in parentheses. The rows above and below the set price bound the question in both directions and are not proposals.

The position on this tier, which should travel with the number wherever it goes

There is no comparable, weak or distant. None. Every other tier in this document can point at a published band and say where inside it the price sits. This one cannot, and a reader who asks will find that out in the first minute. Saying it first is worth more than the tier, because it shows the other four were not decorated either.

10 What a firm faces if it buys nothing

A price is defended twice: against what else the buyer could spend the money on, and against what happens if the buyer spends nothing. The second test is the stronger one here, and it is only partly priced in public. The registration fee and the penalty schedule are published. The annual supervision assessment and the cost of an independent review are not, and neither is estimated below.

The daily ledger duty	Section 15 requires the framework to keep a ledger showing the amount of funds belonging to each end user held at the end of each day. In force since 8 September 2025. This is the duty the subscription is sold against, and a buyer can check it in one click.
Registration, one time	\$2,500 flat and non refundable, payable to the Bank of Canada by every payment service provider, adjusted each year by the consumer price index.
Annual supervision assessment	The formula was pre published in the Canada Gazette in February 2023 and has still not been finalised. The Bank has said it will begin charging once registration closes. No figure exists, so none is carried here.
A compliance officer	Median \$44.10 an hour for a Canadian regulatory compliance officer. A mid level officer runs \$83,000 to \$114,000 a year before employer cost.
The independent review	Section 17 requires one at least once every three years, by somebody who had no part in building the framework. The regulation names no first date and imposes no period the review must cover. No published fee schedule was found in any Canadian source, so the review is recorded as unpriced rather than estimated.
Getting it wrong	A very serious violation by an entity carried up to \$500,000 per violation, raised to approximately \$20 million when Bill C-12 received Royal Assent on 26 March 2026. Penalties are assessed per violation and one examination generates many. A money services business was penalised \$693,742.50 on 27 March 2026.

The avoided cost argument holds at every tier, and it does not need the review to be priced

One mid level compliance officer costs a small firm two to three years of its subscription, and a mid market firm about a year of its own, and does the work by hand. One entity penalty at the maximum in force before Bill C-12 costs more than thirteen years of the small tier. The case for this card does not rest on the software being cheap. It rests on the alternative being a person, a consultant and an exposure, all three of which the firm is already carrying.

11 The ladder read against its evidence

Tier	Locked	In US dollars	Closest benchmark	Read
Command and institution	\$858,750	US\$618,919	MetricStream mid market band	Inside it, thinnest evidence, held
Enterprise and complex	\$274,375	US\$197,748	AuditBoard enterprise band	Inside it, near the top
Mid market regulated	\$104,063	US\$75,000	AuditBoard mid programme band	Middle of the band
Small regulated firm	\$36,813	US\$26,532	Drata observed median	Above it, inside the band
Partner and white label	\$162,500	US\$117,117	None found anywhere	Unbenchmarked, marked as an assumption

Legend. Every tier is measured on the price a firm locks signing from 2028, because that is what the plan collects. Read is the assessment against the benchmark beside it, not a recommendation. Foreign figures converted at the Bank of Canada daily rates of 14 August 2026, 1.3875 for the United States dollar and 1.8790 for the pound sterling. Our figure is the price a firm locks signing from 1 January 2028 and keeps for as long as it stays. Source: 4orm Finance master pro forma of 17 August 2026, base case.

1 What the evidence supports

- Four of the five tiers sit inside a published or observed band.
- None of the five sits above the ceiling of its band.
- The two tiers raised during the review moved from a band floor to a band middle.
- The two tiers held were held because their evidence is thinnest, not because they are correct.

2 What still needs a decision

- Whether the partner tier can be benchmarked before the round.
- Whether a partner and white label benchmark can be sourced before the round.
- Whether the second regulator line stays quoted before a customer signs.
- Whether three enterprise contracts can be signed before the seed is priced.

What would retire the pricing question altogether

Three signed Canadian contracts at the enterprise tier. Every figure in this document is a comparable, which is to say somebody else's contract read from the outside, and no quantity of them is worth one of our own. Until then the ladder is defended on evidence, which is the right way to defend it and not the same thing as proving it.

12 Sources, with the date each was read

What was taken	Publisher, click to open	Read	Class
Sections 15, 17 and 18 in full	Justice Laws, SOR/2023-229	17 Aug 2026	Primary
Registration fee, assessment not finalised	Bank of Canada	17 Aug 2026	Primary
United States and pound sterling rates, 14 Aug 2026	Bank of Canada and sterling	17 Aug 2026	Primary
Penalty amounts and the Bill C-12 maximums	Comply+ penalty schedule	17 Aug 2026	Secondary
The money services penalty of 27 March 2026	FINTRAC public notices	17 Aug 2026	Primary
Revenue, customers and contract bands	Workiva investor releases	17 Aug 2026	Primary
Safeguarding tier pricing, published in full	Guardexia	17 Aug 2026	Primary
Safeguarding scope and entry price	Kani Payments , and Capterra	17 Aug 2026	Primary
Observed contracts by company size	Vendr on Drata , Vanta , Workiva and LogicGate	17 Aug 2026	Secondary
Cost bands by programme size	BD Emerson, on AuditBoard	17 Aug 2026	Secondary
Per user rates and licence bands	VendorBenchmark, on MetricStream	17 Aug 2026	Secondary
Licensing and implementation figures	SmartSuite, on Riskconnect	17 Aug 2026	Secondary
Canadian provider programme and storage budgets	Equilex	17 Aug 2026	Secondary
Compliance officer pay, Canada	AML Incubator	17 Aug 2026	Secondary
Entry tier pricing	Sumsu , and ComplyAdvantage	17 Aug 2026	Secondary

Legend. Primary means read on the publisher's own material: a statutory instrument, a regulator page, an issuer release or a vendor's own site. Secondary means a third party compilation of observed contracts or vendor quotes, which records what buyers paid rather than what a vendor lists. Every publisher above is a link that opens the page the figure was read on.

13 What this document does not claim

Three claims a reader might expect to find here are absent, and each is absent for a reason worth stating rather than leaving to be discovered.

No first review date

Section 17 requires an independent review at least once every three years and imposes no period the review must cover. The regulation names no first date and neither does any Bank of Canada page. Any date a reader wants is arithmetic from 8 September 2025, when the frameworks came into force, and it is offered as arithmetic rather than as a citation.

No lookback

Three years is the longest gap allowed between reviews, not a window a reviewer looks back over. The duty that matters is section 15, the ledger showing each end user's funds at the end of each day, which has applied since 8 September 2025.

No claim that a comparable is a competitor

None of the products priced in this document sells against the Canadian safeguarding duty. They are used to establish what a firm of each size pays for software of roughly this weight, which is a different question from who else a buyer is considering.

How to use this document

Take the reader's tier, give the locked price and the two or three nearest comparables, and let them check. Every figure here was read on the publisher's own material and carries a date. The argument is not that the price is low. It is that the price sits inside a band other people are already paying, for a product that does more than any single one of them.

1 What each tier is measured against

- Command: the MetricStream mid market band, and Workiva's customers above US\$500,000.
- Enterprise: the AuditBoard enterprise band and the top of the observed Workiva range.
- Mid market: the AuditBoard mid programme band and the LogicGate mid deployment band.
- Small: the Drata observed median, the Kani entry price and the Guardexia published card.

2 What would change any of it

- A signed Canadian contract at any tier, which retires the comparable entirely.
- A published Canadian fee for an independent review, which does not exist today.
- A safeguarding vendor entering Canada, which would create a real competitor price.
- A partner benchmark, which is the one gap in the ladder.